INDIA PRICING

Analysts explain reason for iPhone price hike in India

The bigger India story wan't new products, but how Apple raised prices across almost its entire local line-up, with the iPhone 17 up 20.51% to Rs 99,900, the iPhone 17e up 23.11% to Rs 79,900 and the 1TB iPhone Air up 40.65% to Rs 2,24,900. The iPhone Duo's Rs 2,99,900 launch price sits an estimated Rs 80,000 to Rs 90,000 above US and Dubai levels, a gap made up of roughly 17% import duty, 18% GST and a rupee that has slid close to 8% in a year. Analysts are split: Counterpoint expects a low single-digit volume dip offset by 6-7% value growth, while retailers report volumes already down 30-40%. **tinyurl.com/2xzwwtus**



SIRI AI

Apple confirms Siri AI will not be completely free

The rebuilt Siri arrives with iOS 27 on September 14, and Apple has confirmed it will not be unlimited. Siri AI is free to begin with, but subject to a daily cap: cross it and access pauses until the allowance resets. Apple has not said how many requests that allowance covers or when exactly it resets, and has indicated the ceiling may shift depending on the type of feature, how complex the request is and how loaded the system is at the time. Expanded access is expected to arrive as a paid option, most likely folded into higher iCloud+ tiers, though nothing has been priced yet. Apple frames the limits as keeping the experience reliable for everyone, more than anything else. **tinyurl.com/5uhk3uuv**

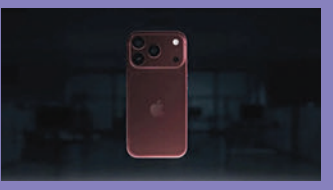


Apple quietly hikes iPhone 17, iPhone Air, AirPods and Apple Watch prices in India after iPhone 18 Pro launch: Check new price



The revisions landed without an announcement, in the hours after the new line-up went live. The iPhone 17 at 256GB moved from Rs 82,900 to Rs 99,900, and its 512GB version from Rs 1,02,900 to Rs 1,24,900, both jumps of over 20%. The iPhone 17e climbed from Rs 64,900 to Rs 79,900 at 256GB, while the iPhone Air went up across every tier, from Rs 1,49,900 at 256GB to Rs 2,24,900 for the 1TB model. Even the older iPhone 16 rose 12.52% to Rs 89,900 at 128GB. Accessories were not spared: the AirPods Pro 3 now costs Rs 27,900, the AirPods Max 2 Rs 74,900 and the Apple Watch SE 3 Rs 29,900. **tinyurl.com/4a4ahmku**

Apple skips iPhone 18 at its September launch event: Here's why the base model may arrive later



John Ternus's first event as CEO, billed Surprise and Shine, delivered the iPhone Duo, the iPhone 18 Pro and the iPhone 18 Pro Max alongside the Watch Series 12, Watch Ultra 4 and AirPods 5. The one obvious absentee was the standard iPhone 18. Three explanations are doing the rounds: an iPhone line-up that has simply grown too crowded for a single keynote, a deliberate move to spread launches through the year so each model gets its own moment, and anticipated memory supply constraints that made a delay the safer call. Three more models, the iPhone 18, the iPhone 18e and a second-generation iPhone Air, are expected in early 2027, according to reports. **tinyurl.com/vz9ccn5v**